



guishes the facility from most soda ash plants globally,” says Kamath.

According to R Mukundan, MD & CEO, Tata Chemicals Limited, sustainability is guided by the Tata Group sustainability initiative, which is steered under the umbrella of Project Aalingana (the Tata Group’s approach to planet resilience and its aspiration to be net

zero by 2045). “It is driven by a vision to protect the world and build the future through technologies of tomorrow. This vision is rooted in our value chain through resource efficiency, emissions reduction and responsible water management,” he says. At the core of all this is strong governance and transparent reporting. “As we move forward, we

remain steadfast in our commitment to responsible growth that delivers long-term value creation while meaningfully supporting climate and sustainability ambitions,” he emphasises. To Mukundan, the *BT* recognition reflects the belief that sustainable practices are fundamental to building resilient, future-ready businesses.

Kamath emphasises that the final phase for Tata Chemicals is the transition towards cleaner energy sources. Its focus has evolved from conserving energy to moving towards natural resources. “Now, it is about embracing cleaner energy solutions such as solar and biomass. We are also evaluating and implementing advanced solutions that include green soda ash technologies, solar thermal and carbon capture,” he says.

This is not without its fair share of challenges – a big one is that operations are highly energy-intensive and include evaporation, drying and stripping that are still dependent on steam generated from fossil fuels. Moving to cleaner sources requires adapting existing boilers for biomass, converting steam-driven equipment to run on renewable electricity.

With modern technology, a lot can be done at scale. Tata Chemicals is now designing its new projects around green energy solutions. That includes mechanical vapour recompression (recycling waste heat) to replace multiple-effect evaporators. At the Cuddalore plant (in Tamil Nadu), existing grid power agreements are being converted to greener power sources, apart from transitioning to captive solar power at other locations. **BT**

@krishnagopalan